

Feature Discovery & Requirements (FDR)

WhatsApp Smart Booking System

1. Executive Summary

Based on the provided project scope, the Indian hospitality sector requires a digital-first, WhatsApp-powered booking solution to replace manual registers and fragmented communication. This document outlines the core platform features and presents critical clarification questions to ensure complete alignment between stakeholders, customers, and the development team before technical execution.

2. Feature Breakdown & Discovery Questions

Feature 1: WhatsApp Guest Enquiry & Automated Bot Flow

Description: Guests initiate enquiries directly via WhatsApp without needing an app download. An automated flow guides them through room availability, options, and the initial booking conversation.

Developer & Customer Clarification Questions:

- ☒ **Language Support:** Will the bot need to support regional Indian languages alongside English to maximize accessibility? X
- ☒ **Human Handoff:** What is the specific trigger or protocol for transferring a complex automated chat to a human front desk agent? → Supervisor call @ 1/2 booking process
- ☒ **Payment Collection:** Does the WhatsApp flow require integration with a payment gateway (e.g., UPI, Razorpay) to secure a deposit, or is it strictly "pay at property"?

Feature 2: Real-Time Booking Engine & Auto-Confirmation

Description: A centralized engine that automatically confirms reservations and syncs data in real-time across the platform to eliminate overbooking and errors.

Developer & Customer Clarification Questions:

- ✗ **OTA & Channel Integration:** Do we need to integrate with external Online Travel Agencies (MakeMyTrip, Agoda, Booking.com) via a Channel Manager so that WhatsApp bookings don't clash with OTA inventory?
- **Modification Policy:** How should the system handle automated requests from guests wishing to modify or cancel an already confirmed booking?
- **Offline Walk-ins:** How quickly can a staff member block a room for a physical walk-in to prevent the automated bot from simultaneously selling that exact room?

Supervisor
Cancel

Feature 3: Front Desk Management Dashboard

Description: A unified live interface for front desk staff to view room availability, process check-ins and check-outs, and receive instant booking alerts.

Developer & Customer Clarification Questions:

- **Guest KYC & Docs:** Must the dashboard include a feature to capture and store mandatory guest ID documents (Aadhar, Passport) during physical check-in? — Check Compliance Policy
- ✓ **Role-Based Access:** Are there distinct permission levels required (e.g., Front Desk Clerk vs. General Manager) to approve complimentary upgrades or manual discounts? Supervisor
- **Invoicing:** Does the system need to automatically generate GST-compliant invoices upon check-out, or will that be handled by a legacy system?

Feature 4: Owner/Manager Analytics & Property Controls

Description: Strategic tools allowing property owners to monitor occupancy, track revenue analytics, identify booking sources, and adjust pricing.

Developer & Customer Clarification Questions:

- **Dynamic Pricing Engine:** Will room pricing be manually adjusted, or do owners expect automated dynamic pricing rules based on current occupancy levels?
- **Reporting Automation:** Do owners require automated daily/weekly summary performance reports sent directly to their personal WhatsApp or email?
- **Multi-Property Support:** Will any of the target owners manage multiple hotel branches through a single consolidated management dashboard?

Feature 5: Staff Alerts & Management Mobile App

Description: A dedicated mobile application that delivers immediate updates and reservation alerts to front desk staff and management.

Developer & Customer Clarification Questions:

- **Platform Rollout:** Is the management app planned for native Android, native iOS, or a cross-platform Progressive Web App (PWA) to save initial development time?
- **Notification Channels:** Aside from in-app push notifications, should critical alerts (e.g., VIP booking, system failure) also trigger an SMS or automated phone call to the manager on duty?

3. Next Steps & Approval

To proceed with accurate technical architecture and timeline estimation, the stakeholders and the development team must review these clarification questions and document the finalized business logic. Once these edge cases are defined, this document will be updated and serve as the baseline for engineering sprint planning.